

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Let's write a cover letter.



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe issues relating to money, in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What is a cover letter? What information do you write in one?
- Do jobs in your country require a cover letter? Why?

Can Do Statements

- I can exchange complex information about my work.
- I can explain how to write a cover letter.
- I can talk about my skills and experiences.





Let's Explore!

Adam writes a fabulous cover letter!

Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Adam Bari
416 Drake Street, Boston, MA
Home: 967-1111 Cell: 439-000
madamiamadam@youremail.com

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the position of Web Content Editor with "Never Odd Or Even" Publishing.

I found your job ad in the Boston Job Fair this morning. Since I am a freelance writer/editor with blog and social media experience, I truly believe I am a strong candidate for the job posting offered in your company.

As you can see in the attached résumé, I hold a BA degree in Communications and Creative Writing from Boston University. I started my career as a reporter for a college magazine. I, then, began working as an editor for a small magazine. I transitioned into a web editor for the online version shortly after. My last experience was working for an independent paper and award-winning magazine called "The News Gazette". These jobs taught me that editing web content is distinctly different from editing print content. My other duties included writing of feature articles for the website, managing content, and selling ad space.

Apart from my experience, I possess great verbal and writing skills with the ability to proofread and edit content in a timely manner so it is ready to be published. I can find any grammatical and spelling errors and have the ability to ensure content matches the writing style adopted by the company.

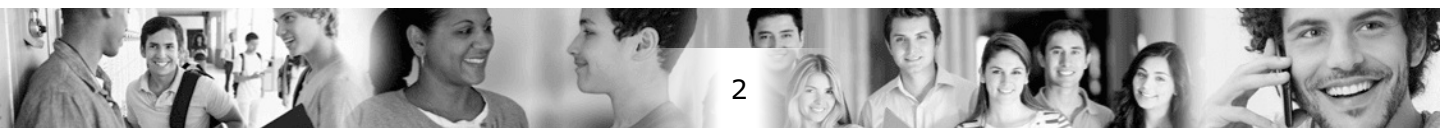
I am an organized and motivated individual who is committed and passionate about what I do. I am able to quickly adapt to new policies and procedures. I have a positive team player attitude with excellent interpersonal skills and always welcome opportunities to upgrade my knowledge and skills.

I would enjoy the opportunity to meet with you personally in order to discuss how my skills enable me to make a valuable contribution to your company.

Thank you for your time and consideration of my application.

Sincerely,

Adam Bari





Let's Practice!

Adam Bari is applying for the position of Web Content Editor.

Instructions: Read the letter. Select all the words that are not correct. Write the correction above them.

Dear Hiring Manager,

I found your job ad in the Boston Job Fair this morning.

I hailed a BA degree in Communications and Creative Writing from Boston University.

I positioned into a web editor for the online version shortly after.

These jobs taught me that editing web content is distinct differ for editing print content. I possess the ability to proffered and edit content on a time man so it is ready to be published. I am an organized and motivated individual who is commitment and passionate about what I do. I am able to quickly adapt to new policies and procedures. I have excellent person skis and always welcome opportunities to upgrade my knowledge .

Thank you for your time and consideration of my application.

Sincerely,

Adam Bari



Let's Practice!

Adam is a strong candidate for the position!

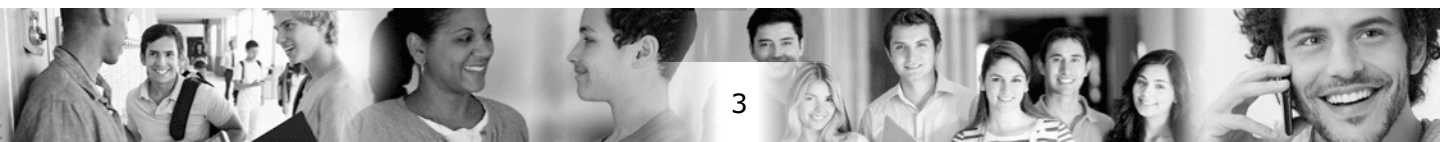
Instructions: Match the words from Column A to the words from Column B.

COLUMN A

1. I am a freelance writer/editor with
2. I truly believe I am a strong candidate for
3. I started my career
4. These jobs taught me that editing web content
5. I began working as

COLUMN B

- a. is distinctly different from editing print content.
- b. as a reporter for a college magazine.
- c. the job posting offered in your company.
- d. an editor for a small magazine.
- e. blog and social media experience.





Extension Activity

Writing a Cover Letter for a Job

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a cover letter to a specific position or opening. Before writing, find out all you can about the company and the position.
- Write a cover letter. Make sure it is 150 to 200 words, and uses Simple Past tense & Present Simple tense.
- Proofread to make sure there are no spelling or grammar errors.
- When you are finished, read your cover letter to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research information about the company and the position.

☐
☐

I write a cover letter with cover letter expressions and Present Simple tense & Past Simple tense.

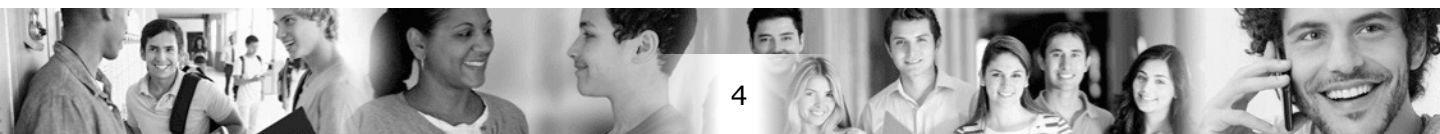
☐
☐

I proofread my cover letter for grammar and spelling mistakes.

☐
☐


Target Words

- to apply for** (verb): to request something by writing or sending a form
e.g. I am applying for the position of Web Content Editor.
- strong candidate** (noun): a very qualified person competing for a job
e.g. I believe I am a strong candidate for this position.
- attached** (adjective): joined or fixed to something
e.g. Please find my résumé attached.
- to hold a degree** (expression): to have a college or university diploma
e.g. I hold a BA degree in Communications and Creative Writing from Boston University.
- to transition** (verb): to change from one situation to another
e.g. I transitioned into a web editor for the online version shortly after.
- distinctly different from** (expression): to not be exactly the same as another thing
e.g. Editing web content is distinctly different from editing print content.
- to proofread** (verb): to read something written and mark any mistakes to be corrected
e.g. I possess great verbal and writing skills with the ability to proofread.
- in a timely manner** (expression): happening at the most suitable time
e.g. I can edit content in a timely manner so it is ready to be published.
- committed** (adjective): loyal to an organization and willing to work hard for it
e.g. I am an organized and motivated individual who is committed and passionate about what I do.
- interpersonal skills** (noun): ability to create good relationships between yourself and other people
e.g. I have a positive team player attitude with excellent interpersonal skills.





Learning Points

Past Simple Tense vs. Present Simple Tense

When you write a résumé, it is common to use a mixture of tenses. You can use the past and present.

You use the **Simple Present** tense to talk about permanent situations or about things that happen regularly.

- *Since I am a freelance writer/editor with blog and social media experience, I truly believe I am a strong candidate for the job posting offered in your company.*
- *I hold a BA degree in Communications and Creative Writing from Boston University.*
- *I am an organized and motivated individual who is committed and passionate about what I do.*
- *I have a positive team player attitude with excellent interpersonal skills and always welcome opportunities to upgrade my knowledge and skills.*

You use the **Simple Past** tense to talk about many kinds of past events: short, quickly finished actions, longer situations and repeated events.

- *I found your job ad in the Boston Job Fair this morning.*
- *I started my career as a reporter for a college magazine.*
- *I began working as an editor for a small magazine.*
- *These jobs taught me that editing web content is distinctly different from editing print content.*





Learning Points

Cover Letter Expressions

A Cover Letter is a letter you send along with your résumé. It is considered to be the first official contact between an employer and a potential employee. Therefore, you need to make sure it is well-written. Here are some phrases and expressions you can use when writing a Cover Letter.

1. Say that you would like to apply

I am applying for the position of (name of the position) with (company's name).

2. Say where you found out about the job

I found your job ad in (name) (when)

I found your job ad in the Boston Job Fair this morning.

3. Say why you are qualified for the job.

Since I am a (job) with (describe experience) blog and social media experience, I truly believe I am a strong candidate for the job posting offered in your company.

Since I am a freelance writer/editor with blog and social media experience, I truly believe I am a strong candidate for the job posting offered in your company.

As you can see in the attached résumé, I hold a (name of degree) from (name of university).

I started my career as a/an (describe position) for (place/company)

My other duties included (describe other things you did)

Apart from my experience, I possess (describe qualities and strengths) with the ability to (describe what you can do for the company)

4. Say you can provide more information if necessary.

I would enjoy the opportunity to meet with you personally in order to discuss how my skills enable me to make a valuable contribution to your company.

5. Say how thankful you are.

Thank you for your time and consideration of my application.

